

Professional Identity Statement Template

Instructions: Read Crafting a One-Minute Counselor Professional Identity Statement by Burns (2017). In this article, Burns (2017) outlines 7 steps to follow to craft a professional identity statement and provides examples of statements. Outline your answers to each step and then draft a complete counselor professional identity statement that is approximately 150 words.

Step 1: Defining the audience/role

Graduate student in School Counseling presenting a professional identity statement for academic evaluation.

Step 2: Defining who

George Dranichak, master's student in School Counseling with a background in linguistics.

Step 3: Defining what

Counseling grounded in building strong, trusting relationships through support, rapport, and connection, while emphasizing growth, empowerment, and understanding.

Step 4: Defining who and where

Works with students navigating challenging home environments and those who struggle with decision-making, supporting them in developing healthier patterns and more constructive choices.

Step 5: Defining what

Uses narrative therapy and reflective, conversation-based approaches to help students reframe their experiences, explore identity, and take ownership of their personal growth.

Step 6: Defining why

Clients seek support for feeling overwhelmed, misunderstood, or struggling with expression, behavior, or identity.

Step 7: Defining how by establishing credibility

Member of the American School Counselor Association and a graduate student at St. Bonaventure University. I have experience working with students with communication difficulties and behavioral needs; academic training and research in neurodivergence and counseling approaches.

Professional Identity Statement (Approximately 150 words)

My name is George Dranichak, and I am a graduate student in School Counseling with a background in linguistics. I approach counseling through building strong, supportive relationships with students, prioritizing rapport, trust, and genuine connection as the foundation for growth. I am particularly interested in working with students navigating difficult home environments and those who struggle with decision-making, helping them develop healthier patterns and more constructive ways of approaching challenges.

I use narrative therapy and reflective, conversation-based approaches to help students make sense of their experiences, reshape the stories they tell about themselves, and take ownership of their personal growth. Many of the students I work with feel overwhelmed or misunderstood, and I strive to create a space where they feel heard, respected, and capable of change.

As a member of the American School Counselor Association and a graduate student at St. Bonaventure University, I bring both professional commitment and practical experience supporting students with diverse needs.